

**KARTIK NARAYAN**CEO-STAFFING,
TEAMLEASE
SERVICES

“**Auto-claim settlement enhancement, simplified PF transfers and online member profile updates will ease the burden of employees who want to withdraw their funds**”

THE IMPACT

- The reforms have helped in faster claim settlement
- The EPFO now receives 99.31% claims online; auto claims are cleared in three days

	FY25	FY24
Number of claims settled (million)	60.1	44.5
Amount settled (₹lakh crore)	2.41	1.82

	FY25	FY24
Number of auto claims settled (million)	23.4	9
Amount disbursed (₹crore)	32,848	12,605

SOURCE EPFO ANNUAL REPORT 2023-24

But once in place, the new system will make the back-end processes much faster, leading to quicker approvals and fewer rejections. Both subscribers and PF officials will have consolidated data on the portal, reducing errors and delays. Grievances have already started coming down with the availability of digital services for KYC-validated subscribers. The EPFO is hopeful that its latest measures will further reduce complaints.

As part of the upgrade, it will also transition to an Aadhaar-enabled payment system using the NPCI platform; the payment will be directly transferred into the subscriber's Aadhaar-linked bank account, leading to faster settlements.

R. Karumalaiyan, National Secretary, CITU and Member, CBT, says the EPFO was struggling with old infrastructure and even MeitY asked it to focus on a revamp. “The EPFO has certainly worked on improving its IT infrastructure and compliance processes, which has proved beneficial for subscribers,” he says.

Narayan of TeamLease Services says the EPFO's IT infrastructure is archaic. “Systems need to talk to each other. Bulk transfers within PF offices are not yet enabled. The EPFO is not equipped for smooth movement of accounts in mergers and acquisitions,” he says.

EPFO 3.0

In fact, the next on the retirement fund manager's to-do list is a much bigger revamp of systems and processes and scaling up of infrastructure. This is important to meet the challenge of planned rollout of a universal social security under which it expects its subscriber base to more than double as informal sector workers also join the scheme.

Called EPFO 3.0, the project is still at the planning and discussion stage but is likely to be started later this year and completed by June 2026. The customer portal of the EPFO that often sees long downtimes and remains inaccessible to subscribers for days will be revamped. A mobile app is also being discussed. “Today, everyone wants real-time information and access to their funds. A mobile app could be the way forward,” says a source.

The EPFO is also looking to use artificial intelligence, business analytics and machine learning to lower the workload on employers and its own officers. It may also enable withdrawals through UPI.